NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES

Community-Based Organization • Northern Kenya

"Resilient Communities, Brighter Futures."

INAUGURAL ANNUAL REPORT

Founding Year | Community Listening & Engagement

2025 – 2026



Listening to communities. Learning together. Building solutions.

ABOUT NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES

Northern Resilience Initiatives (NRI) is a newly established community-based organization dedicated to improving the lives of people in Northern Kenya. We work closely with local communities to identify their needs and implement sustainable initiatives in education, water security, women's and youth empowerment, environmental conservation, and sustainable livelihoods.

This inaugural report covers our founding period and the first major activity of the organization: going into communities to listen, learn, and begin shaping solutions together.

Our Mission

To work alongside communities in Northern Kenya to improve lives through education, water security, youth and women's empowerment, environmental conservation, and sustainable development initiatives that create lasting positive change.

Our Vision

Thriving communities in Northern Kenya empowered to overcome challenges, harness opportunities, and build a sustainable future for present and future generations.

YEAR IN REVIEW: LISTENING TO THE COMMUNITY

As a newly established organization, NRI's priority in this founding period was not to arrive with ready-made projects, but to listen. We spent time with pastoralist communities, women, youth, children, and household leaders to understand their lived realities, challenges, and priorities.

These engagement sessions formed the foundation of our work. They ensure that every programme we design responds to real needs identified by the people we serve.



Community dialogue under the trees



Sitting together to share challenges

What the engagements involved

- Open community dialogues in pastoralist settlements
- Conversations with women, youth, elders, and household heads
- Learning about daily struggles around water, drought, livelihoods, education, and protection
- Discussing possible solutions that communities themselves can own and sustain
- Building trust and relationships that will guide future programme design

WHAT WE HEARD: KEY CHALLENGES

Communities spoke openly about the pressures they face. The challenges below emerged consistently across the listening sessions and align closely with NRI's programme focus areas.

Water Security & Climate Stress

- Recurring drought and prolonged dry seasons
- Limited access to safe and reliable water for households and livestock
- Inadequate water storage and rainwater harvesting infrastructure
- Growing impact of climate change on pastures and daily survival

Women, Girls & Household Well-being

- Heavy burden on women and girls for water collection and household care
- Limited opportunities for skills, savings, and income generation
- Concerns around girls' education, school retention, and protection
- Need for stronger support for vulnerable women and widows

Youth & Livelihoods

- Limited pathways for skills development and employment readiness
- Desire for mentorship, leadership, and entrepreneurship support
- Pressure on traditional livelihoods under changing climate conditions



Standing discussions with community leaders



Standing with the communities we serve

SOLUTIONS DISCUSSED WITH COMMUNITIES

Listening was paired with joint discussion of practical, community-owned responses. The ideas below reflect priorities that communities raised and that NRI is preparing to support.

- Installation of water storage tanks and rainwater harvesting systems
- School water access support to improve learning conditions and reduce burden on girls
- Community drought preparedness and awareness sessions
- Tree planting and environmental conservation initiatives
- Skills development, savings groups, and entrepreneurship support for women
- Mentorship, life skills, and leadership opportunities for youth
- Educational support and protection initiatives for girls
- Targeted support for vulnerable households during drought emergencies

OUR IMMEDIATE PROGRAMME FOCUS

Guided by what communities shared, NRI will prioritise water security and climate resilience as the first area of action while laying foundations for women's empowerment, girls' education, and youth development.

1. Installation of water storage tanks
2. Rainwater harvesting projects
3. Community drought preparedness and awareness
4. Tree planting and environmental conservation
5. School water access support

LOOKING AHEAD

This founding year was about presence, trust, and understanding. The next phase is about turning listening into lasting change.

In the coming period, NRI will:

- Design and launch pilot water and climate-resilience projects informed by community input
- Deepen partnerships with communities, local leaders, government, and development partners
- Expand structured programmes in women's empowerment, girls' education, and youth development
- Strengthen organisational systems for transparency, accountability, and learning
- Continue regular community feedback so programmes remain relevant and owned locally

We remain committed to working alongside communities, government, and partners to create sustainable solutions that improve lives and build resilient communities across Northern Kenya.

WHO WE SERVE

Women	**Youth**	**Children**	**Vulnerable households**
Schools	**Community groups**	**Pastoralist communities**	

CONTACT US

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Thank you to every community member who opened their space and shared their story.
Together, we build resilient communities and brighter futures.